

\$TONKS

Study Guide



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Introduction

\$tonks is a real-time stock market simulation. In this category, you will receive crisis updates as news updates. You are to invest your allocated funds strategically and aim to achieve the highest total valuation by the end of the 3rd round. The three rounds will be on Days 1, 2 and 3 of Empresario. Each team begins with an initial capital of \$100,000, which you can use to trade among 12 stocks spanning different sectors.

The simulation consists of three rounds, each lasting 95 minutes. News updates will guide market conditions, including 5 major updates (10 min each) and 5 minor updates (5 min each). Between updates, a 2 minute recess will be provided. Stock information and updates will be revealed through the \$tonks website. Each delegation will be emailed unique login credentials that they will use to log in to the portal, and are to remain logged in throughout the duration of the round. News updates will be shared on the screen during the round. You can view stock details and execute trades here. A company portfolio will also be provided for each of the available stocks prior to the category.

Key market variables like inflation, natural resource scarcity, competition, and geopolitical conflicts will impact stock prices. For each stock being traded on the PB Stock Exchange, delegates will receive a brief company profile outlining relevant information about the public company.

The winner is determined based on the highest total valuation at the end of Round 3. There is no delegate cap. Good luck, and may your investments flourish.

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COMPANY PROFILES

1. Maan Energy (ME):

Headed by Hateez Maan, Maan Energy is the primary IPP contractor for Pakistan's power generation and currently has around 50 power generation plants, mostly relying on fossil fuels. The company is currently looking to expand into more renewable sources like wind and HEPs and wants to renew its contracts with the government that are ending by 2035.

2. The Unusual (UNU):

Headed by Asad Ilias, The Unusual is a leading fashion brand that primarily deals with beauty products ranging from hair care to de-tanning products. Their primary customer base is young males, and they are looking to expand to products targeting females. Ilias is also quite wary of his son, Zoraiz Ilias, who is looking to gain control of the empire his father has built. While Ilyas insists that succession is a family matter, rumours of disagreements within the company have already begun affecting its management.

3. Wattoo Fertilizers and Co. (WFC):

An agricultural empire to describe the company would be an understatement. The company is the major supplier of fertilizers to all local farmers spanning from KPK to Punjab and have their own factories for such. Owned by the proud Wattoo family hailing from Okara, the company has at one point been single-handedly responsible for 40% of Pakistan's agricultural exports, the produce from its own farmlands. The company, however, in recent times has seen structural problems with the Founder and CEO, Mr. Wattoo, falling ill and the 2 sons being incapable of managing the company's affairs. The board is currently attempting to determine which son out of the two is less incapable.

4. Zarainobox Productions Limited (ZPL):

A new Gen Z-led production house hailing from the streets of Gosha-ae-ahbab is a relatively new startup looking to break the norms of previously bland and monotonous Pakistani Dramas. The production house, owned by Zara Farrukh, has started to collaborate with Brown TV to make new blockbuster hits like “Main kabhi kabhi tum”. However, there are unconfirmed reports of the company having unusually long working hours, particularly for their male employees.

5. Brown TV Limited (BTL):

A company that initially started out as a comedy channel with game shows such as “Jeeto Punjab” with stars like Mustafa Fahad has now evolved to making Dramas, a News Channel, and even selling gold. This vast diversity of sectors has led to the company not being able to properly manage its sectors, with problems stemming from basic logistical work to a decrease in quality of production. Their recent partnership with Zarainobox has helped in this regard, but the company still has a long way to go before someone remembers what the original business plan was.

6. Mawera Energy (MWE):

A company that came about as a direct result of the solar boom in Pakistan has now grown from a local venture for solar grids in Lahore to being a problem for Maan Energy itself. The company specialises in providing solar equipment to people and commercial businesses to ease the burden of electricity bills and shortfalls in Pakistan. The success of the company can only be attributed to its owner, Mr Sheikh, who, despite being rigid in the way the company functions from day to day, has brought the company to new heights.

7. WUM TV (WTV):

A channel that once saw great hits like “Wo Humnawan Tha” is merely a stain on its legacy due to a lack of critically acclaimed dramas for almost a decade. New companies and the evolution of its competitors in the form of Zarainobox and Brown have further reduced its relevance and market share within the industry. The company is now headed by the daughter of its founder, Syed Wajih Waqas ul Shozab. Laiba is a charismatic leader who looks to restore the company's former status.

8. Khokhar Pharmaceuticals Limited (KPL):

Khokhar Pharmaceuticals is one of Pakistan's leading pharmaceutical manufacturers, supplying hospitals and pharmacies all over the nation. The company has traditionally benefited from strong demand and government contracts, but much of its raw material is imported. A sudden shortage of essential medicines has recently placed the company under government scrutiny. Meanwhile, its ambitious CEO, Ahmed Khokhar, who started the company after a failed career in law, wants to enter the lucrative international market despite concerns from the company's board that he may be attempting to run before he can walk, or in other words, he may be trying to fly a rocket without understanding its science.

9. Gujjar Dairy & Bakers (GDB):

A family-owned dairy empire based in Gujrat, Gujjar Dairy & Bakers has grown from a small collection of cattle farms into one of Pakistan's largest producers of milk, yogurt, butter, cream and other dairy products. Headed by the notoriously stubborn Mustaghis Gujjar, the company controls a large portion of the dairy and bakery supply chain. Recently, the company has faced rising costs due to animal feed prices, shortage of flour, tariffs on electricity, and increasing competition from competitors such as Zaka Milkers. However, Gujjar refuses to drop prices as he claims, “Dood, Makhan aur Ladu; Maang Raha Hai Har Insaan”

10. Pluto Caterers (PLC):

A well-established catering business in Lahore that was once started by selling biryani in the trunk of a Vezel, Pluto Caterers has built its reputation through large-scale weddings, corporate events, and private functions across Punjab. Offering extensive menus and being able to handle an event of almost any size, the company has begun looking beyond traditional catering and expanding into food production and distribution. However, costs of meat, dairy, flour, and other ingredients put pressure on Pluto's margins.

11. Waseem Bank Limited (WBL):

A state-of-the-art premier bank is enough of a statement to describe WBL. A Bank that in the past saw exponential growth under the great Mr. Haziq Waseem still maintains its legacy; however, its growth has stagnated in recent times due to competition from other mainstream brands that provide better financing options and more attractive loans. Yet, WBL still maintains its influence due to the well-established relations with major industrialists and even the government. The new CEO, Mr. Wajih, looks to modernize the bank while making sure to stay to its roots as a major stabilizing force within the industry.

12. Khichi Bank Limited (KBL):

A direct competitor of WBL, Khichi Bank has taken a new approach to the industry by offering aggressive loans to both regular consumers as well as commercial businesses. Their digital banking app is also a key selling point for consumers opting in, yet it still has not been able to match WBL in terms of its customer base and influence due to unknown forces working against them. Mr. Khichi himself states that there are "external influences working against them" and has repeatedly mentioned "Big Brother," a personality responsible for such forces.